



WEEKLY DENGUE UPDATE

Week 21 (18th – 24th May 2026)

National Dengue Control Unit, Ministry of Health

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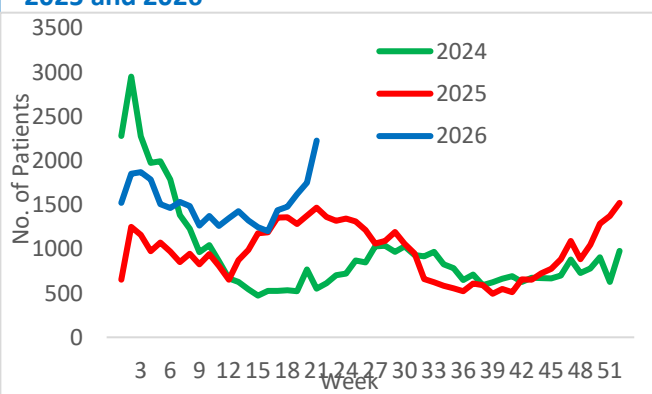
Week
21

Year: 2026 Volume: 06 Issue: 21

DENGUE CASE REPORTING

During the 21st week, 2227 suspected dengue cases were reported across all 26 districts, compared to 1751 cases in the previous week, reflecting an 27.2% increase. The Western Province accounted for 50.2% of total cases, with the Colombo Municipal Council (CMC) contributing 3.6%, the rest of Colombo District 19.4%, Gampaha District 18.8%, and Kalutara District 8.4%. Outside the Western Province, notable case contributions were reported from Ratnapura (10.4%), Kandy (8.4%), Matara (7.4%), Galle (6%), Kegalle (2.9%), Batticaloa (2.2%), and Hambantota (2.2%), (see Table 1).

WEEKLY DISTRIBUTION OF DENGUE PATIENTS in 2024, 2025 and 2026



Source: NaDSys – National Dengue Surveillance System

HIGH RISK MOH AREAS

As presented in Table 2, during the 21st week of 2026, 72 Medical Officer of Health (MOH) areas were identified as high-risk, including 25 newly flagged areas (highlighted in light red in Table 2). Previously classified 3 high-risk MOH areas in week 20, were not identified as high-risk in the 21st week of 2026 (Table 2).

MIDNIGHT TOTAL OF DENGUE PATIENT ADMISSIONS

* After incorporating delayed hospital reports, the average midnight total for the 20th week decreased from 664 to 663.

In the 21st week of 2026, the average midnight total of dengue patients across 74 sentinel hospitals was 781. Compared to the previous week, in the 21st week, 31 hospitals reported an increase, while 16 reported a decrease.

Table 3 highlights sentinel hospitals with high average midnight totals and changes in dengue admissions during the 20th week.

Table 1: Reported dengue cases in week 21 and week 20 of 2026

District/ RDHS	No. of cases					
	2025		2026		Up to Week 21	
	Week 20	Week 21	Week 20	Week 21	2025	2026
Colombo	347	361	356*	512	5982	8366
Gampaha	215	212	340*	419	3302	5228
Kalutara	44	55	129*	186	890	2146
Kandy	100	115	129*	188	1391	1410
Matale	10	21	19*	11	580	391
Nuwara Eliya	3	7	11*	16	76	127
Galle	51	57	107	133	989	2057
Hambantota	20	20	44*	48	387	929
Matara	33	31	94	165	737	2186
Jaffna	19	15	21	16	491	550
Kilinochchi	7	1	Nil	5	40	41
Mannar	6	Nil	4	2	89	40
Vavuniya	2	Nil	7	1	22	58
Mullaitivu	Nil	1	Nil	2	8	23
Batticaloa	52	56	45	48	1317	911
Ampara	4	4	12	4	63	215
Trincomalee	37	36	17	19	675	389
Kalmunai*	11	6	25	33	254	592
Kurunegala	50	45	44	32	520	819
Puttalam	11	9	24	27	353	549
Anuradhapura	9	5	10	10	246	243
Polonnaruwa	11	6	17	18	143	237
Badulla	14	21	17	25	304	384
Monaragala	10	19	15	11	382	415
Ratnapura	263	311	197*	232	2646	2240
Kegalle	40	45	67*	64	592	883
Total*	1369	1459	1751*	2227	22479	31429

Source: NaDSys (Dengue Surveillance, National Dengue Control Unit)

*Ampara district is divided into two Regional Directorates of Health Services (RDHS) as Ampara & Kalmunai

■ Districts reporting higher number of cases.

* Week total may vary slightly due to the deletion of duplicate entries. Inter-district transfers can affect the district total

Table 2: High risk MOH areas

MOH Area	Cases reported		MOH Area	Cases reported		MOH Area	Cases reported		MOH Area	Cases reported	
	Week 20	Week 21		Week 20	Week 21		Week 20	Week 21		Week 20	Week 21
WESTERN PROVINCE			Biyagama	93	114	Weligama	9	21	Addalaichchenai	11	15
Colombo District			Gampaha	14	21	Welipitiya	0	11	NORTH WESTERN PROVINCE		
Battaramulla	15	22	Ja-Ela	20	30	Galle District			Puttalam District		
Boralesgamuwa	11	17	Katana	17	14	Bope Poddala	16	36	Wennappuwa	2	15
Dehiwala	7	16	Kelaniya	37	51	Elpitiya	9	10	SABARAGAMUWA PROVINCE		
Egodaayana	8	10	Mahara	34	44	MC Galle	11	15	Ratnapura District		
Gothatuwa	24	35	Minuwangoda	26	25	Thawalama	13	15	Ayagama	8	16
Hanwella	34	30	Pugoda(Dompe)	18	29	CENTRAL PROVINCE			Elapatha	6	10
Homagama	22	31	Ragama	10	15	Kandy District			Embilipitiya	14	19
Kaduwela	49	50	Seeduwa	15	20	Gampola	6	14	Godakawela	6	10
Kahathuduwa	19	17	Wattala	17	25	Gangawata	10	19	Kahawatta	9	14
Kesbewa	13	13	Kalutara District			Korale			Kalawana	7	11
Maharagama	51	77	Bandaragama	8	19	Kandy MC	20	32	Kuruvita	16	17
Moratuwa	14	19	Bulathsinhala	10	14	Thalathuoya	2	10	Nivithigala	14	21
Padukka	8	38	Horana	24	27	Udunuwara	3	11	Pelmadulla	14	24
Piliyandala	10	16	Ingiriya	19	30	Waththegama	11	10	Rathnapura MC	42	34
Pitakotte	14	17	Madurawala	4	13	Werellagama	8	11	Ratnapura PS	30	23
Rathmalana	4	13	Panadura	16	22	Yatinuwara	26	33	Kegalle District		
CMC			Wadduwa	4	12	UVA PROVINCE			Dehiovita	15	22
D2B-CMC	4	18	SOUTHERN PROVINCE			Badulla District					
D3-CMC	10	22	Matara District			Badulla	6	11			
D4-CMC	8	10	Akuressa	2	10	EASTERN PROVINCE					
Gampaha District			Dickwella	3	10	Batticaloa District					
Aththanagalla	13	11	Matara MC	33	50	Batticaloa	18	14			
			Matara PS	3	14	Kalmunai District					

Table 3: Sentinel hospitals with high average midnight totals in the 21st week

Hospital	Average Midnight Total			Hospital	Average Midnight Total			Hospital	Average Midnight Total		
	Week 20	Week 21			Week 20	Week 21			Week 20	Week 21	
NIID	74	84	↑	DGH - Negambo	23	26	↑	DGH - Embilipitiya	5	10	↑
TH - Ratnapura	67	64	↓	DGH - Awissawella	19	21	↑	TH - Batticaloa	12	10	↓
TH-Matara	46	62	↑	TH - Kurunegala	28	20	↓	BH - Kamburupitiya	9	9	-
TH – Colombo South	31	46	↑	DGH - Gampaha	20	19	↓	BH - Wathupitiwala	3	6	↑
TH – Colombo North	28	42	↑	LRH	19	19	-	DGH - Hambantota	2	5	↑
NHSL	34	41	↑	TH - Kalutara	12	18	↑	BH - Balangoda	10	5	↓
NH - Galle	24	37	↑	BH - Panadura	7	15	↑	DGH - Nawalapitiya	4	5	↑
TH - Peradeniya	26	35	↑	BH - Tangalle	10	14	↑	BH - Minuwangoda	4	5	↑
DGH - Horana	26	33	↑	BH - Kahawatta	10	13	↑	BH - Marawila	2	5	↑
NH - Kandy	18	29	↑	PGH - Badulla	10	11	↑	DGH - Kegalle	3	5	↑

Table 4: Dengue related deaths

	2025	2026		2025	2026
Reported Deaths	29	16	Case Fatality Rate	0.05%	0.05%

Deaths reported in 2026 [Districts/Admin area]					
District/area	No	District/area	No	District/area	No
Colombo	3	Gampaha	4	NIHS Kalutara	1
Hambantota	2	Galle	1	Kandy	1
Ratnapura	2	Kalutara	1	Trincomalee	1

Deaths reported in 2026 [Age & Sex]					
Age Group (Yrs)	Male	Female	Age Group (Yrs)	Male	Female
0-14	1	2	45 - 54	0	1
15-24	0	1	55 - 64	0	1
25-34	1	0	> 64	1	4
35-44	0	4	Total	3	13

